ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** planned	Central control
2	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false, R true
3	**(b)** Choices involve costs, so facts reduce waste	Evidence-based choice
4	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Non-exclusive goods
5	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Time has alternative uses
6	**(d)** cost of labour influences technique	Labour cost matters
7	**(a)** 1.2 kg wheat	30/25 = 1.2
8	**(b)** for whom to produce	Different groups
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Spending an hour on play means giving up the next best use of that hour (such as study), so opportunity cost exists without money.
10	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both statements are true (private enterprise and government participation co-exist), but the timing of the Survey does not explain why India is mixed.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It creates jobs (1); It reduces unemployment (1).	1+1
12	Needs depend on situation (1); A mobile phone is a need for a delivery worker, a want for a child (1).	1+1
13	Time and attention are limited (1); Every use of money or time means giving up another (1).	1+1
14	Future needs and growth depend on saving and investment (1); Sustainability needs balanced use (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Household: share between food and savings (1); Firm: workers versus machines (1); Government: schools versus roads (1).	1+1+1
16	New technology reduces cost of machines (1); It encourages automation (1); Skilled labour demand rises (1).	1+1+1
17	Shows efficient combinations (1); Shows trade-offs (1); Helps set priorities (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Parks, roads, street lights (1); Difficult to charge users (1); Little profit for firms (1).	1+1+1
18	Reviews sectors and inflation (1); Points out challenges (1); Helps allocate limited funds (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Competition may lower prices (1); But public goods and equity may be neglected (1); Hence regulation is needed (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) She gives up 10 kg of wheat (100 - 90) (1). (ii) 90 - 70 = 20 kg of wheat (1). (iii) No; this point lies outside the PPC, so it cannot be produced with the given resources (1). (iv) She gives up 40 kg wheat for 25 kg barley, i.e. 40/25 = 1.6 kg wheat per kg barley (1); the cost rises because the resources are not equally suited to producing both goods (1).	1+1+1+2
20	Overuse of water for sugarcane (1); Soil health damage (1); Millets protect resources (1); Policy and awareness matter (1); Sustainability reduces future scarcity (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: What: size and type (1); How: machines or hand-stitching (1); For whom: students from low-income families (1); Costs and technology (1); Opportunity cost of choices (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Opportunity cost is **not** the money spent or every alternative given up; it is the value of the **next best** alternative given up.
- Do not confuse *needs* and *wants*: food, water and shelter are needs; a designer watch or holiday trip is a want. Wants keep changing and growing.

- A PPC slopes **downward**. A point inside it means resources are under-used; a point outside it is not attainable with the given resources.
- Scarcity means limited resources compared with unlimited wants. It does not mean poverty, and it affects governments and firms as well as households.
- Match systems correctly: Cuba and North Korea are planned economies, the USA is a market economy, and India is a **mixed** economy.
- Do not mix up labour-intensive (handicrafts, traditional farming) with capital-intensive (steel, automobiles), or the three questions: what, how and for whom to produce.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the bridge's benefit of 4 units	Best alternative forgone
2	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false: government is referee
3	**(b)** Hospital built - school not built	Choice between projects
4	**(b)** More capital-intensive production	Cheaper capital
5	**(d)** Making affordable low-fat milk packs for low-income families	Target group
6	**(c)** a mixed economy	Regulation and welfare
7	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false, R true
8	**(d)** an output not possible with current resources	Beyond capacity
9	**(c)** A is true but R is false.	Wants keep growing, so A is true; resources are limited (scarce) with alternative uses, so R is false.
10	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A point inside the PPC means resources are not fully or efficiently used, so A is false; R is a correct description of points on the PPC.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Private firms do not provide them without profit (1); They benefit all and support development (1).	1+1
12	Poor may be unable to pay (1); Public goods may be neglected (1).	1+1
13	Government and private aims may conflict (1); Regulation can create delays and inefficiency (1).	1+1
14	Firms cut prices to attract buyers (1); Quality improves to keep customers (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Sugarcane yields high profit (1); Uses much water and harms soil (1); Millets save resources and last longer (1).	1+1+1
16	5 cheap toys per expensive toy (1); Cheap toys suit lower-income buyers (1); Expensive toys suit richer buyers (1).	1+1+1
17	Private firms dominate many sectors (1); Government regulates and provides public goods (1); Welfare schemes continue (1).	1+1+1
	OR: More firms enter and competition rises (1); Prices fall and quality improves (1); Government must still regulate safety (1).	1+1+1
18	Rising cost of labour (1); Better technology (1); Customer preference for speed (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Many groups with competing needs (1); Large resources to allocate (1); Long-term effects on millions (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Planned economy (1). (ii) Market economy; the USA (1). (iii) Z has a mixed economy; India is also regarded as a mixed economy (1). (iv) Drawback of a planned economy: little motive to improve quality or innovate (1); strength of a market economy: competition leads to better quality and innovation (1).	1+1+1+2
20	Planned: central control, little competition (1); Market: demand and supply, private ownership (1); Mixed: combines both (1); Developing country needs growth and welfare (1); So a mixed economy suits best (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Markets guide resources by demand and supply (1); Competition promotes innovation (1); But public goods are under-supplied (1); The poor may be left out (1); So government support is needed (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Air available freely in an open field	Scarce means limited
2	**(d)** Street lights are public goods used by all	Public good
3	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Increasing cost
4	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	Presented before the Budget
5	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Sacrificed profit
6	**(b)** limited competition	Restrictions
7	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Trade-off
8	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Mixed economies are common
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Because the resources are fixed, more barley means less wheat; this trade-off gives the downward slope.
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Because no one can be excluded and profit is hard to earn, private firms under-provide them and the government steps in.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Resources diverted from domestic goods (1); Fewer goods for local consumption (1).	1+1
12	Licences limited production (1); Little competition meant poor efficiency (1).	1+1
13	Scarcity is relative to wants and exists even in rich nations (1); Poverty is lack of means to meet basic needs (1).	1+1
14	It lies beyond the maximum possible output (1); So not attainable with present resources (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Actual table shows costs of 10, 20, 30, 40 kg per 25 kg barley (1); So cost rises (1); Neighbour is wrong (1).	1+1+1
16	Opportunity cost shows what is lost (1); Sustainability looks at future (1); Together they give balanced policy (1).	1+1+1
17	Time used for one activity cannot be used for another (1); Choosing a subject means giving up others (1); Planning improves use of time (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Output follows paying capacity (1); Poor lack income (1); Governments must provide welfare (1).	1+1+1
18	What to buy with income (1); How to meet needs, cook at home or eat out (1); For whom, kids, elders, guests (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Choice between two uses (1); Giving up the other is the cost (1); Compare benefits and urgency using data (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) How to produce (1). (ii) A method using many workers and relatively few machines (1). (iii) Capital-intensive (1). (iv) 'For whom to produce' (1); producers choose the cheaper way of production, so when labour becomes costly and machines become cheap, using more machines lowers the cost (1).	1+1+1+2
20	What: school uniforms, sports or designer wear (1); How: machines or hand work depending on cost (1); For whom: income and taste of buyers (1); Technology and laws also matter (1); All are choices because resources are scarce (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Acts like a referee (1); Provides public goods and infrastructure (1); Ensures safety, fair competition and welfare (1); Too much control can reduce innovation (1); Balance is needed, as in a mixed economy (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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